The Fairy Inkcap mushroom, *Coprinellus disseminatus*, is an inkcap species that can be found in Singapore. It is a saprophytic fungus that grows on nutrient-rich substrates such as dead trees, fallen branches, leaf litter, grassy debris, and bare soil. It can be recognised by its small, delicate caps with slender white stripes and densely packed gills, and often grows in large clusters. *Coprinellus disseminatus* is also considered the most widely distributed species within the *Coprinellus* genus, and was given its current scientific name in 1939 by the Danish mycologist Jakob Emanuel Lange.

This paper mache artwork depicts several fairy inkcaps growing on soil near fallen wood and dead branches, from which they obtain nutrients. When young, the caps are more egg-shaped and white or tannish in colour. As they mature, the caps gradually expand into a more umbrella-like shape and become greyer or brownish in colour. On the underside of the caps are gills that release spores for reproduction. Unlike most other coprinoid mushrooms, *Coprinellus disseminatus* does not dissolve into black ink (deliquesce) when mature.

While it predominantly exists as a saprophyte, research has shown that it can also form mycorrhizal associations with certain orchid species, such as *Cremastra appendiculata*, helping to support their seed germination.

In addition, studies have found that *C. disseminatus* contains natural compounds such as phenols and flavonoids, which are known for their antioxidant properties to help neutralise free radicals, and may have potential as a source of beneficial natural compounds that could be explored for health-related applications, such as nutraceuticals.

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